

“ I KNOW OF **NO OTHER MAN** IN OUR TIME, OR INDEED **IN RECENT HISTORY**, WHO SO CONVINCINGLY DEMONSTRATED THE **POWER** OF THE **SPIRIT** OVER **MATERIAL THINGS**. ”

Sir Stafford Cripps, British statesman, on Gandhi, 1948



Harry Truman holds up a newspaper that prematurely announced Thomas Dewey had won the election.

power and replaced by the leader of the Czech communist party, **Klement Gottwald** (1896–1953; see 1989). This was a tense period in Czechoslovakia. **Jan Masaryk**, the Czech foreign minister, had tried to assure the Soviets that a democratic Czechoslovakia posed no security threat. However, he had been in favor of accepting aid from the **Marshall Plan** (see 1947), which Stalin refused to endorse. On March 10, the Czech government reported that Masaryk had committed suicide. Despite suspicions that the communists had murdered Masaryk, nothing was proven.

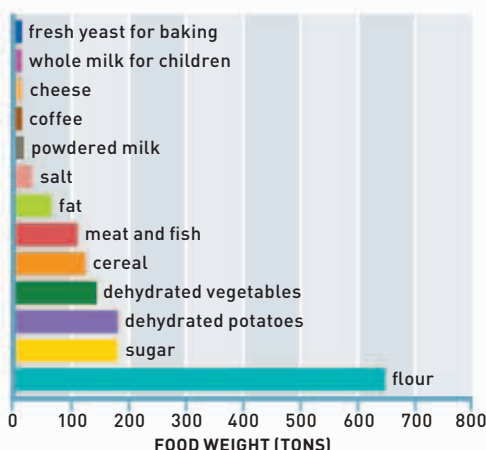
Berlin was divided into **four zones** after World War II, under an agreement between Britain, France, the US, and Russia (see 1961). Berlin as a whole was an enclave within Soviet-occupied East Germany. The Soviets were determined to force Western powers out of Berlin and, in the **first crisis of the Cold War**, cut

The Berlin Airlift

A crowd of Berliners watch a Douglas C-54 Skymaster plane carrying vital supplies to the Allied sectors of the city.

road and rail links between the city and the West in June. The Allies responded to the “**Berlin Blockade**” by organizing a massive **airlift** to supply the people of Berlin, and the blockade was lifted in May 1949.

The end of World War II brought **mass movements of refugees** as millions of displaced people fled or were expelled from Eastern Europe. Many were treated brutally and found it hard to assimilate. In response, the UN adopted the **Universal Declaration of Human Rights**, which guaranteed a “right to seek and to enjoy in other countries asylum from persecution,” as well as the Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide.



Feeding Berlin

At the height of the Berlin blockade, one plane reached Berlin every 30 seconds. This graph shows the quantity of food that was flown in daily to sustain Berlin's 2 million citizens.

